



Homeschooling in Georgia

A Legal Rights & Resources Guide
for Diverse Families

For Black, Brown, LGBTQ+, and special-needs
homeschool & hybrid-learning families

A SEAT Squad Digital Download · Updated June 2026

Important: This Is Not Legal Advice

This guide is for informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Laws change frequently — especially ESA programs and education legislation.

Always verify against primary sources before making decisions about your family's education. Key sources are listed throughout this guide and in the resource section. If your situation involves custody, special needs disputes, or legal concerns, consult a Georgia-licensed education or family law attorney.

This guide reflects laws and programs as of **June 2026**. Verify before relying on any specific detail.

How to Use This Guide

This guide walks you through everything a diverse homeschooling family needs to know to legally homeschool in Georgia, access available scholarship funds, navigate special needs services, and understand the legal landscape for LGBTQ+ families.

What's Inside

1. **Your Homeschooling Option** — Georgia's Home Study Program (the only legal option)
2. **Home Study Program Requirements** — Step by step: declaration, attendance, subjects, testing, records
3. **The Promise Scholarship (ESA)** — Georgia's new education savings account program
4. **Special Needs Scholarship (GSNS)** — Funding for students with IEPs
5. **Special Needs Provisions** — IEP rights, services access, accommodations
6. **LGBTQ+ Family Considerations** — What Georgia's laws mean for your family
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8. **Templates & Checklists** — Declaration of Intent checklist, attendance tracker, portfolio guide

HOW GEORGIA COMPARES TO FLORIDA

If you're familiar with our Florida guide, here are the key differences:

- **More regulation:** Georgia requires teacher qualifications (high school diploma/GED), 180 instructional days, 4.5 hours per day, specific subjects, and national testing every 3 years. Florida requires none of these for its Home Education Program.
- **Less universal ESA:** Georgia's Promise Scholarship is limited to students from the lowest-performing 25% of public schools. Florida's PEP is universal — any student can apply.
- **More LGBTQ+ friendly:** Georgia has no "Don't Say Gay" law, no bathroom bill, no drag ban, and its hate crime law explicitly includes sexual orientation. Atlanta has the largest Pride parade in the Southeast.
- **Single option:** Georgia has one legal homeschooling path (Home Study Program). Florida has three (Home Education, Private School Umbrella, PEP).

SECTION 1

Your Homeschooling Option in Georgia

Unlike Florida, which offers three paths, Georgia has **one legal option** for homeschooling: the **Home Study Program**, established under O.C.G.A. § 20-2-690(c). There is no private school umbrella option and no separate ESA-for-homeschoolers program like Florida's PEP. However, you can enroll your child in a private school (which is a different legal category, not "homeschooling") and you may be eligible for the Promise Scholarship or Special Needs Scholarship depending on your situation.

Georgia Home Study Program at a Glance

Requirement	Georgia
Legal basis	O.C.G.A. § 20-2-690(c)
Compulsory attendance ages	6–16
Notification	Yes — Declaration of Intent, annually by September 1
Parent qualification	High school diploma or GED required
Instructional days	180 days per school year
Instructional hours	At least 4.5 hours per day
Required subjects	Reading, language arts, math, social studies, science
Testing	National standardized test every 3 years (starting 3rd grade)
Record keeping	Annual progress report (retained, not submitted)
Immunization	Not required for home study students

Georgia is more regulated than many states. The 180-day, 4.5-hour requirement, the parent qualification requirement, the mandated subjects, and the testing requirement are all enforceable. While Georgia does not aggressively prosecute homeschooling families who comply in good faith, you should take these requirements seriously and maintain documentation of compliance.

SECTION 2

Home Study Program Requirements

Step 1: File Your Declaration of Intent

Within **30 days** of starting your home study program, and by **September 1** of each subsequent year, you must submit a **Declaration of Intent to Utilize a Home Study Program** to the Georgia Department of Education.

The declaration must include:

- Names and ages of the children who are enrolled
- The location of the home study program (your address)
- The time frame for the school year (start and end dates)
- A statement declaring that the home study program is being conducted

The Georgia DOE provides an **online portal** for submitting the Declaration of Intent electronically. You can also submit by mail. Search for "Georgia Declaration of Intent homeschool" at gadoe.org to find the current portal.

Keep a copy of your filed Declaration of Intent. The DOE portal typically generates a confirmation or receipt. Save this — it's your proof of compliance. You may need it for dual enrollment applications, driver's license requirements (for teens), or other situations where you need to prove your child is legally being homeschooled.

Step 2: Meet the Parent Qualification

The parent or instructor providing the home study program must have a **high school diploma or equivalent (GED)**. This is a minimum requirement — you do

not need a teaching certificate or college degree. If you are using a tutor or co-op instructor for some subjects, that person must also meet this qualification.

Step 3: Provide 180 Days of Instruction

Your home study program must provide **180 days of instruction** per school year, with each school day consisting of at least **4.5 hours** of instruction. This is a total of 810 instructional hours per year.

The 4.5 hours can include any educational activity you direct: reading, hands-on projects, co-op classes, field trips with educational purpose, online courses, physical education, art, music, and more. You do not need to replicate a public school schedule.

How to track this: Keep an attendance log showing each instructional day. Mark the date and hours. This doesn't need to be submitted to anyone, but you must have it in your records. See the templates section for a tracker you can use.

Step 4: Teach the Required Subjects

Georgia requires that your home study program include instruction in five core subjects:

1. **Reading**
2. **Language arts** (writing, grammar, spelling, literature)
3. **Mathematics**
4. **Social studies** (history, geography, civics, economics)
5. **Science**

You can teach these in whatever way works for your family — textbooks, living books, online courses, project-based learning, unit studies, co-op classes. The statute specifies the subjects but not the content, so you have freedom in *how*

you teach them. This means you can use culturally responsive materials, diverse perspectives, and inclusive content freely.

Beyond the required subjects: You can add any additional subjects you want — art, music, foreign languages, financial literacy, coding, life skills, cultural history, LGBTQ+ history, etc. The statute doesn't limit you to only the five required subjects. It just requires that those five are included.

Step 5: National Standardized Testing

Your student must take a **nationally normed standardized achievement test** every **three years**, starting at the end of 3rd grade (so typically 3rd, 6th, 9th, and 12th grades).

Important: You do **not** need to submit the test results to the state or your school district. You must retain them in your records. The test is for your own assessment of your child's progress.

Commonly used tests include:

- Iowa Test of Basic Skills (ITBS)
- Stanford Achievement Test (SAT-10)
- California Achievement Test (CAT)
- Woodcock-Johnson Tests of Achievement
- Brigance Comprehensive Inventory of Basic Skills

Step 6: Write an Annual Progress Report

You must write an **annual progress assessment report** for each student in your home study program. This report should evaluate your child's academic progress in each required subject area.

You do not need to submit this report to the state or school district. You must retain it in your records for at least three years. Think of it as documentation for your own purposes and as evidence of compliance if ever questioned.

PROGRESS REPORT TIPS FOR DIVERSE FAMILIES

- Include both academic progress and social/emotional development
- Note any culturally relevant projects, community involvement, or life skills developed
- For special needs learners, include progress on IEP goals (if applicable) and accommodations used
- The report can be brief — a summary paragraph per subject is sufficient
- Digital reports (Google Doc, PDF) are acceptable as long as you can produce them if asked

What Your Homeschooled Student CAN Access

Georgia home study students have the right to:

- **Participate in extracurricular activities** at their local public school (per SB 388, 2012 — the "Equal Access" law). This includes sports, clubs, band, and other activities.
- **Dual enrollment** in Georgia colleges and universities through the Move On When Ready (MOWR) / Dual Enrollment program
- **HOPE Scholarship and Zell Miller Scholarship** for college funding (requires meeting GPA and course requirements — verify current requirements at gafutures.org)
- **Georgia Virtual School** online courses

SECTION 3

The Promise Scholarship (Georgia's ESA)

The Georgia Promise Scholarship is the state's ESA (Education Savings Account) program. It was created by **SB 233**, signed into law in 2024, and began rolling out for the 2025-2026 school year. It is administered by the **Georgia Education Savings Authority (GESA)**.

Key difference from Florida: Georgia's Promise Scholarship is **NOT universal**. Unlike Florida's PEP, which is open to all students, Georgia's ESA is limited to students enrolled in the **lowest-performing 25% of public schools** as defined by the state's CCRPI (College and Career Ready Performance Index) scores. This significantly narrows who can access it.

Who Is Eligible

- Students enrolled in a Georgia public school that ranks in the **bottom 25% of CCRPI scores**
- The student must have been enrolled in a Georgia public school for at least the **prior school year**
- The student must be a Georgia resident
- Students from families at any income level may be eligible (verify current income requirements with GESA)

If your child has never been enrolled in a Georgia public school, or attends a school outside the bottom 25%, you are likely NOT eligible for the Promise Scholarship. This is a major limitation compared to Florida's universal program.

How Much Funding

The Promise Scholarship provides approximately **\$6,500 per student per year** in an education savings account that families can use for approved educational expenses.

Verify the current year's amount with the Georgia Education Savings Authority before applying. The exact figure may adjust based on state funding allocations.

What Promise Funds Can Cover

- **Private school tuition** and fees at approved private schools
- **Tutoring** and instructional services
- **Curriculum** and instructional materials
- **Educational therapies** and specialized services
- **Online courses** and virtual school programs
- **Educational technology** (devices, software) within guidelines
- **Transportation** to and from the educational setting

Can Promise funds be used for homeschooling? The Promise Scholarship is designed for students *leaving* a low-performing public school to attend a private school or participate in a parent-directed educational program. If you withdraw your child from a qualifying public school to homeschool, you may be able to use Promise funds for curriculum, tutoring, and materials — similar to Florida's PEP. **Verify this directly with GESA** before relying on it, as the program rules are still being finalized.

How to Apply

PROMISE SCHOLARSHIP APPLICATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Verify your child's school is in the bottom 25% of CCRPI scores
- ☐ Confirm your child was enrolled in a Georgia public school for the prior year
- ☐ Check GESA's website for application dates and deadlines

- ☐ Gather proof of Georgia residency
- ☐ Gather proof of public school enrollment
- ☐ Complete the Promise Scholarship application through GESA
- ☐ If approved, set up your ESA account
- ☐ Begin using funds for approved educational expenses

The Promise Scholarship is new and evolving. SB 233 was passed in 2024, and the program's implementation details, eligibility rules, and funding amounts may change. Always check the GESA website or contact them directly for the most current information before making decisions based on this scholarship.

SECTION 4

Georgia Special Needs Scholarship (GSNS)

Georgia has a separate scholarship program specifically for students with disabilities: the **Georgia Special Needs Scholarship (GSNS)**, created by SB 10 in 2007. This is different from the Promise Scholarship and has its own eligibility requirements.

Who Is Eligible

- The student must have a current **IEP (Individualized Education Program)**
- The student must have been enrolled in a Georgia public school and received **special education services** for at least the prior school year
- The student must be a Georgia resident
- There is no income requirement

Key limitation: If your child has never been enrolled in a Georgia public school with an IEP, they are likely not eligible for GSNS. This is the same pattern as the Promise Scholarship — Georgia's school choice programs generally require prior public school enrollment.

How Much Funding

The GSNS award amount varies based on the student's disability category and the state funding that would have followed them to their public school. Awards typically range from approximately **\$3,000 to \$12,000+ per year** depending on the student's needs and disability classification. Students with more significant disabilities generally receive higher awards.

What GSNS Funds Can Cover

- **Private school tuition** at a GSNS-approved private school that serves students with disabilities
- **Services** provided by approved providers
- The scholarship is paid directly to the private school or provider, not to the parent

How GSNS Differs from Florida's FES-UA

- **FES-UA (Florida):** ESA-style account, parent-directed, funds for therapies + curriculum + tutoring + more, no prior public school enrollment required, can be used for homeschooling expenses
- **GSNS (Georgia):** Scholarship paid to private school/provider (not parent-directed ESA), requires prior public school enrollment with IEP, primarily for private school tuition
- **Bottom line:** Georgia's program is less flexible and less parent-directed than Florida's. If you want to homeschool a special needs child in Georgia and use state funds for therapies and materials, the Promise Scholarship (if your school qualifies) may actually be more useful than GSNS, despite not being special-needs-specific.

How to Apply for GSNS

GSNS APPLICATION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Confirm your child has a current IEP
- ☐ Confirm your child was enrolled in a Georgia public school and received special education services for the prior year
- ☐ Search for GSNS-eligible private schools on the GaDOE website
- ☐ Apply directly through the GaDOE GSNS portal (typically opens in spring/summer)
- ☐ The scholarship is awarded for the school year and must be renewed annually

SECTION 5

Special Needs Provisions

IEP Rights for Georgia Homeschoolers

If your child has an IEP from a Georgia public school and you withdraw them to homeschool:

- **The IEP document remains valid** as a record of your child's needs, even though the public school is no longer required to implement it
- **Keeping the IEP current matters** if you want to access GSNS — you need a current IEP to qualify
- **You are not required to follow the IEP** at home, but it's a useful guide for understanding your child's needs and the services they were receiving
- **Child Find obligations still apply** — the school district is still legally required to identify and evaluate children who may need special education services, even if they are homeschooled. If you suspect your child has an undiagnosed disability, you can request an evaluation from your local school district.

Services Available to Homeschooled Students with Disabilities

- **Evaluation services** through your local school district (Child Find)
- **Georgia Department of Education — Division for Special Education** can provide guidance on services available to home study students
- **Georgia Parent Mentor Partnership** — parents who have navigated special education in Georgia providing peer support
- **Parent to Parent of Georgia** — statewide organization supporting families of children with disabilities, including training on special education rights
- **Extracurricular activities** at your local public school (SB 388) — includes adaptive sports and special needs programs if your school offers them

- **Get the IEP before you withdraw** if at all possible. Once you're homeschooling, it's harder to get a new IEP because you're no longer enrolled. If your child is currently in public school and you're considering homeschooling, request an evaluation first.
- **Keep all documentation** — IEPs, evaluation reports, progress data, therapy notes. You'll need these for GSNS eligibility and for tracking your child's progress.
- **Therapy access is a challenge in Georgia** — unlike Florida's FES-UA which lets you use ESA funds for therapies directly, Georgia's GSNS only pays for services at approved private schools. If you need standalone therapies (speech, OT, PT), you'll need to use private insurance, Medicaid (if eligible), or pay out of pocket.
- **For neurodivergent learners**, the 4.5-hour daily requirement can be adapted — break it into shorter sessions, include sensory breaks, and count hands-on and life-skills learning as instructional time.

SECTION 6

LGBTQ+ Family Considerations

Georgia's legal landscape for LGBTQ+ families is **significantly better than Florida's**. While there are some restrictions (particularly around transgender healthcare for minors), Georgia does not have a "Don't Say Gay" curriculum law, no bathroom bill, no drag ban, and its hate crime law explicitly includes sexual orientation. Atlanta is one of the most LGBTQ+ friendly cities in the South.

What the Laws Say

NO "DON'T SAY GAY" EQUIVALENT

Unlike Florida, Georgia does **not** have a law restricting classroom instruction on sexual orientation or gender identity. There is no state-level prohibition on teaching LGBTQ+ history, discussing diverse families, or including LGBTQ+ content in curriculum.

What this means for homeschoolers: You're free to include LGBTQ+ content in your curriculum without legal concern — but this was already true for homeschoolers in any state. The bigger difference is that *public school* families in Georgia have more freedom than those in Florida, which means the urgency to homeschool for curriculum reasons is lower in Georgia.

SB 140 — TRANSGENDER HEALTHCARE RESTRICTIONS (2023)

Georgia passed SB 140 in 2023, which restricts certain gender-affirming medical care for minors. The law prohibits surgical interventions for minors and restricts the administration of hormone therapy. It does **not** ban all gender-affirming care — mental health counseling and social transition support are not prohibited. However, it does create barriers to medical transition for transgender youth.

What this means for families: If your child is transgender and may need gender-affirming medical care, this law creates legal barriers. Some families

seek care out of state. Consult with a knowledgeable healthcare provider and legal advocate for your specific situation. This is an area of active legal challenge and may evolve.

TRANSGENDER SPORTS PARTICIPATION

Georgia has restricted transgender student-athlete participation in school sports. The Georgia High School Association (GHSA) adopted a policy requiring transgender athletes to participate in sports based on their sex assigned at birth. If your transgender child wants to participate in public school sports through the home study equal access provision, this policy may apply.

ANTI-DISCRIMINATION PROTECTIONS

Georgia offers more protections than many Southern states:

- **Hate crime law** (2020) explicitly includes sexual orientation — one of the few Southern states to do so
- **Employment discrimination** is prohibited based on sexual orientation and gender identity under federal law (*Bostock v. Clayton County*, which originated in Georgia) and the 11th Circuit's *Glenn v. Brumby* decision
- **Local anti-discrimination ordinances** in several cities and counties: Atlanta, Clarkston, and Doraville have full protections (public + private employment); Athens, Decatur, Savannah, Avondale Estates, East Point, and others have public employment protections
- **Atlanta** has comprehensive protections and is one of the most LGBTQ+ friendly cities in the Southeast

ADOPTION AND PARENTAL RIGHTS

- **Adoption:** Same-sex couples have full adoption rights in Georgia (HB 159, 2018 — no restrictions)
- **Foster care:** Same-sex couples can serve as foster parents. A 2018 bill (SB 375) that would have allowed religious-based discrimination in adoption was

passed by the Senate but killed in the House — it did not become law.

- **IVF and surrogacy:** No restrictions
- **Same-sex marriage:** Legal since 2015 (Obergefell v. Hodges)

NO BATHROOM BILL, NO DRAG BAN, NO DEI RESTRICTION

Unlike Florida, Georgia does **not** have:

- A bathroom/restroom law targeting transgender people
- A restriction on drag performances or "adult live performances"
- A prohibition on state funding for DEI efforts
- A law requiring schools to out LGBTQ+ students to parents

This makes Georgia a generally safer and more comfortable state for LGBTQ+ families than Florida, Tennessee, or several other ESA states.

BULLYING PROTECTIONS

Georgia law bans bullying in schools, though it does not specifically list protected groups (sexual orientation, gender identity) in the anti-bullying statute. If your child participates in public school extracurriculars and experiences bullying, you can report it under the general anti-bullying law.

Protective Steps for LGBTQ+ Families

- **Legal documents:** If you are a same-sex couple, ensure both parents have legal parental rights established. Georgia allows second-parent adoption, and the process is generally more straightforward than in some other states. Consult a Georgia family law attorney.
- **Estate planning:** Wills, powers of attorney, and healthcare surrogacy documents remain important even in a more protective state. Don't skip these.
- **Healthcare advocacy:** For transgender family members, SB 140 creates barriers. Identify supportive healthcare providers before you need them.

Georgia Equality and Atlanta-based LGBTQ+ organizations can provide referrals.

- **Curriculum freedom:** Georgia does not restrict your ability to teach LGBTQ+ history, diverse families, or affirming content in your homeschool. Take advantage of this freedom.
- **Know your city's protections:** If you live in Atlanta, Clarkston, or Doraville, you have comprehensive local anti-discrimination protections. Other cities have varying levels of protection. Know what applies where you live.
- **Atlanta is a resource hub:** Atlanta has one of the largest LGBTQ+ communities in the South, hosting Atlanta Pride (the largest Pride parade in the Southeast), the Atlanta LGBT Center, and numerous family-supportive organizations and events.

SECTION 7

Inclusive Resources in Georgia

Verify all contact information and program details before relying on them.

Scholarship & Legal Resources

Resource	What they do	Contact
Georgia Department of Education	State education agency. Handles Declaration of Intent, GSNS, and general homeschooling information.	gadoe.org 404-656-2800
Georgia Education Savings Authority (GESA)	Administers the Promise Scholarship (ESA) program	Search for current website/contact at gadoe.org
GA Futures	College planning, HOPE Scholarship, Zell Miller Scholarship, and dual enrollment information	gafutures.org
HSLDA	Legal support for homeschooling families (note: conservative Christian orientation)	hslda.org
Coalition for Responsible Home Education (CRHE)	Inclusive, secular homeschool law information and advocacy	responsiblehomeschooling.org

LGBTQ+ Family Resources

Resource	What they do	Contact
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Georgia Equality	Statewide LGBTQ+ advocacy organization. Legislative tracking, referrals, community events.	georgiaequality.org
Atlanta LGBT Center	Community center with programs, support groups, library, and events for LGBTQ+ individuals and families.	thelgbtcenter.org
PFLAG Atlanta / Georgia chapters	Family support for LGBTQ+ people and their families. Multiple chapters statewide.	pflag.org
Lost-n-Found Youth	Atlanta-based organization serving LGBTQ+ homeless youth. Community resource for families in crisis.	lost-n-found.org
Georgia Safe Schools Coalition	Works to make Georgia schools safer for LGBTQ+ students. Resources applicable to families navigating public school access.	Search for current contact

Cultural & Community Resources

Resource	What they do	Contact
National Black Home Educators (NBHE)	National network with Georgia presence. Conferences, mentorship, community.	nbhe.net
Black Homeschoolers of Georgia	Statewide support and community for Black homeschooling families. Search Facebook for current group.	Facebook groups
Atlanta-area inclusive co-ops	Metro Atlanta has multiple secular and inclusive co-ops. Search "Atlanta secular homeschool" or "Atlanta inclusive homeschool" on Facebook.	Facebook groups
Hispanic/Latino homeschool groups	Atlanta, Dalton, and other areas with significant Hispanic populations have bilingual and culturally responsive homeschool groups.	Search Facebook
African American Homeschoolers	National network with active Georgia members.	Search Facebook

Network		
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Special Needs Resources

Resource	What they do	Contact
Parent to Parent of Georgia	Statewide organization supporting families of children with disabilities. Training, peer support, IEP help.	p2pga.org
Georgia Department of Behavioral Health & Developmental Disabilities (DBHDD)	Services for individuals with developmental disabilities and behavioral health needs.	dbhdd.georgia.gov
Georgia Council on Developmental Disabilities (GCDD)	Advocacy and programs for Georgians with developmental disabilities.	gcdd.org
Disability Rights Georgia	Legal advocacy organization for people with disabilities. Protection and advocacy system for Georgia.	disabilityrightsga.org
Parent Mentor Partnership	Georgia DOE program connecting parents of children with disabilities with experienced parent mentors.	Search at gadoe.org

General Homeschooling Support

Resource	What they do	Contact
Georgia Virtual School (GAVS)	Free online courses for Georgia students, including home study students.	gavirtualschool.org
Georgia Home Education Association (GHEA)	Statewide homeschool support organization. Convention, resources, legal information.	ghea.org

CHEA of Georgia	Christian homeschool association (note: faith-based, may not be affirming for all families)	Search for current contact
4-H Georgia	Youth development programs open to homeschoolers statewide.	georgia4h.org

Finding inclusive co-ops in Georgia: Georgia has a strong homeschooling community, particularly in metro Atlanta. When searching, ask about inclusion policies. Atlanta-area secular and inclusive co-ops are active — search Facebook for "Atlanta secular homeschool," "Decatur homeschool co-op," or "inclusive homeschool Georgia." Faith-based co-ops are also common; some are affirming and some are not. Ask directly.

SECTION 8

Templates & Checklists

Declaration of Intent Checklist

- ☐ Access the Georgia DOE Declaration of Intent portal (search "Georgia Declaration of Intent" at gadoe.org)
- ☐ Fill in parent/guardian name and address
- ☐ List all children: names and ages
- ☐ Provide the study location (your home address)
- ☐ Enter the school year time frame (start and end dates)
- ☐ Confirm the parent/instructor has a high school diploma or GED
- ☐ Submit electronically or by mail
- ☐ Save the confirmation receipt
- ☐ Mark your calendar: submit again by September 1 each year

Attendance Tracker (180 Days, 4.5 Hours Each)

Month	Instructional days completed	Running total	Notes
August	_____	_____	
September	_____	_____	
October	_____	_____	
November	_____	_____	
December	_____	_____	
January	_____	_____	
February	_____	_____	

March	_____	_____	
April	_____	_____	
May	_____	_____	
June (if needed)	_____	_____	
July (if needed)	_____	_____	
TOTAL		_____ / 180	

Required Subjects Tracker

Subject	Curriculum / approach used	Progress notes
Reading		
Language arts		
Mathematics		
Social studies		
Science		

Annual Progress Report Template

Annual Progress Assessment Report

School Year: _____

Student Name: _____

Grade Level (parent-assigned): _____

Reading: _____

Language Arts: _____

Mathematics: _____

Social Studies: _____

Science: _____

Additional subjects / activities: _____

Overall assessment of progress: _____

Date: _____

Parent signature: _____

Retain this report in your records for at least 3 years. Do not submit to the state.

Scholarship Application Tracker

Program	Eligible?	Applied?	Status	Award amount
Promise Scholarship (ESA)	☐	☐		
GSNS (Special Needs)	☐	☐		

HOPE Scholarship (college)	☐	N/A (apply senior year)		
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Testing Schedule

Grade	Test required?	Test used	Date administered	Results retained?
3rd grade	Yes			☐
6th grade	Yes			☐
9th grade	Yes			☐
12th grade	Yes			☐

FOR THE SELLER

Verification Checklist (For You)

This section is for you (the guide creator), not for the buyer. Use this checklist before listing.

- ☐ Verify the Georgia DOE Declaration of Intent portal URL and process (gadoe.org may have restructured)
- ☐ Verify the 180-day / 4.5-hour requirement is still current in statute
- ☐ Verify required subjects list (reading, language arts, math, social studies, science)
- ☐ Verify national standardized testing requirement (every 3 years, starting 3rd grade)
- ☐ Verify Promise Scholarship eligibility (bottom 25% CCRPI, prior public school enrollment)
- ☐ Verify Promise Scholarship funding amount (~\$6,500) for current year
- ☐ Verify GESA website and contact information
- ☐ Verify GSNS eligibility requirements and application process
- ☐ Verify GSNS award range and whether parent-directed use is allowed
- ☐ Verify SB 140 (transgender healthcare) is still in effect and check for legal challenges
- ☐ Verify transgender sports policy (GHSA) is still current
- ☐ Check for any new LGBTQ+ legislation since June 2026
- ☐ Verify all resource organization contact info is current
- ☐ Update the "as of" date on the cover page
- ☐ Replace [Your SEAT Squad sign-up URL] on the bonus page
- ☐ Generate a real QR code for the bonus page

Update schedule: Georgia's Promise Scholarship is new and evolving — check for implementation changes frequently. Review this guide at least **twice per year**. The Promise Scholarship rules are particularly likely to change as the program matures.



Need Guides for Other States?

This Georgia guide is part of a growing series of state-by-state homeschooling legal guides for diverse families. Get notified when new state guides are available.



Scan or visit
to join the community

[Your SEAT Squad sign-up URL here]

Free Resources for SEAT Squad Members

- ♥ Florida state guide (available now)
- ♥ North Carolina, Arizona, Tennessee guides — coming soon
- ♥ Free inclusive homeschooling resource directory
- ♥ Banned book reading lists by grade level
- ♥ Financial literacy workbooks for diverse families
- ♥ Cultural history unit studies
- ♥ Monthly updates on legislation affecting diverse homeschooling families

Joining is free. You'll get new resources every month, plus a
community of families learning together.

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